OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

PILGRIMAGES TO MEDJUGORJE & LOURDES 2027 Deposits and Savings scheme available on Thursdays in Parochial House from 10.30am-12noon.beginning in October. contact Margaret 07732468511

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel: Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

ACCORD DERRY MARRIAGE PREPARATION WORKSHOPS November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

Derry Diocesan Young Adult Community: Derry Youth Ministry invites everyone aged 18–35 to join their new community every Tuesday evening at 7:30pm, starting 20 October, at Claudy Pastoral Centre. Each week features a varied programme including invited speakers, scripture, prayer, food, and fellowship, alongside organised social events. Everyone is welcome to come along! For more details, please contact yvonne.rooney@derrydiocese.org.

RISE AND SHINE TRUST Do you know a young person who would benefit from a week of friendship, fun, faith and unforgettable memories in Lourdes? Rise & Shine Trust brings children (11+) and young adults with additional needs on a week-long pilgrimage holiday to Lourdes each Easter. The trip is free for our guests as our volunteers fundraise for it. For more information, and to apply, please see www.riseandshine.ie. Applications for the 2027 Easter Pilgrimage are currently open and close on 15th October 2026.

JOB OPPORTUNITY Derry Diocesan Trust Choir Director– St Eugene's Cathedral Church 10 hours per week For job description and application pack please contact: Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, (028) 7126 2302 or email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications must be returned to: Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than noon Friday 16th October 2026.

Sun 11th Oct 2026 Vol 44 No 41

MASSES
Saturday Vigil 6.00pm
Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm
Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS
Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm
Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm
Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS
Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES
Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE
71267070
1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ
Email:office@holyfamily-parish.com
Website: www. holyfamily-parish.com
Webcam: Click on website and follow the links
Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

The Invitation of Grace

Matthew 22:1–14

In today's Gospel, Jesus compares the Kingdom of Heaven to a wedding feast. Everything has been prepared by the king, yet those first invited refuse to come, preoccupied with their own affairs. Others are invited, both good and bad, reminding us that God's love is a gift, not something we earn.

But what about the guest without a wedding garment? The garment represents a life transformed by God's grace, particularly through love and charity.

There are two dangers in our spiritual lives: believing we must make ourselves worthy of God's invitation, or accepting that invitation without allowing His love to change us.

Christian holiness is neither striving to prove ourselves nor remaining unchanged. It is surrendering to Christ and allowing His grace to work within us.

We do not earn our place at God's table. We receive His invitation and allow His love to transform us.

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Eileen Walls, Elizabeth Moyne, Robbie Herron, Mary King, Bessie McCartney

SUNDAY COLLECTION 4th October £2513.17 & €194.36 Standing Orders £400 **2nd Collection** £1161.16 & €62.87. Separate from the collection Fr Gormley would like to acknowledge these donations also £1000, £120, £500, £1000, £80 and £300 during the month of September. Thank you for your generosity

HOLY FAMILY SCRIPTURE GROUP meets on **Thursday at 6.00pm** in the Upper Room This is a sacred time to come together to listen and reflect as Jesus speaks to each of us through His Word in scripture All welcome **Please note change of time.**

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD We pray that the men called to be priests of our diocese will know the truth of St Paul's words in our second reading, "There is nothing I cannot master with the help of the One who gives me strength."

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

THINKING ABOUT PRIESTHOOD? Are you 18 years or older and thinking or wondering about serving the church as a priest of the diocese of Derry? There will be an afternoon talk with time for prayer, discussion, questions & answers in Derry on Sunday 11 October. For further details please contact Fr Pat O'Hagan at pgoh2111@gmail.com

THORNHILL MINISTRIES will lead an introduction to the practice of praying Scripture in a reflective way that will help participants let the Word of God to nestle in the quiet corner of the heart. '*Open heart - Open to the Word'* series of Sundays in October 3:30 - 4:30 pm Emmaus Room, Pennyburn Church. All welcome

ANAM CARA'S next Bereavement Information Evening will will take place online on Thursday 15 October at 7pm. Bereaved paretns are very welcome to register https://bit.ly/OctBIE

PRAY FOR THE NATIONAL GATHERING OF THE CHURCH IN IRELAND: Bishops, priests, religious and lay people from across Ireland will gather for the National Synodal Assembly on Saturday, 17 October, to pray, listen and discern what God may be asking of the Catholic Church in Ireland at this time. Bishop Michael Router and seven delegates will represent the Diocese of Derry. Please remember Bishop Michael, our diocesan delegates and everyone taking part in your prayers. Find out more on: https://derrydiocese.org/national-synodal-assembly

The Columban Young Adults are a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, who are seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. Our October event will be a Holy Hour and meditation next Thursday 15th October, 7:00pm at our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, delivered by Fr Declan McGeehan. The meditation will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. We are actively seeking new members- please come along and bring a friend!

LUMEN CHRISTI COLLEGE 30TH anniversary Gala event in the Everglades Hotel, Friday 23rd October: Night at the Races, meal and dancing! Tickets available from the college reception. All welcome**!**